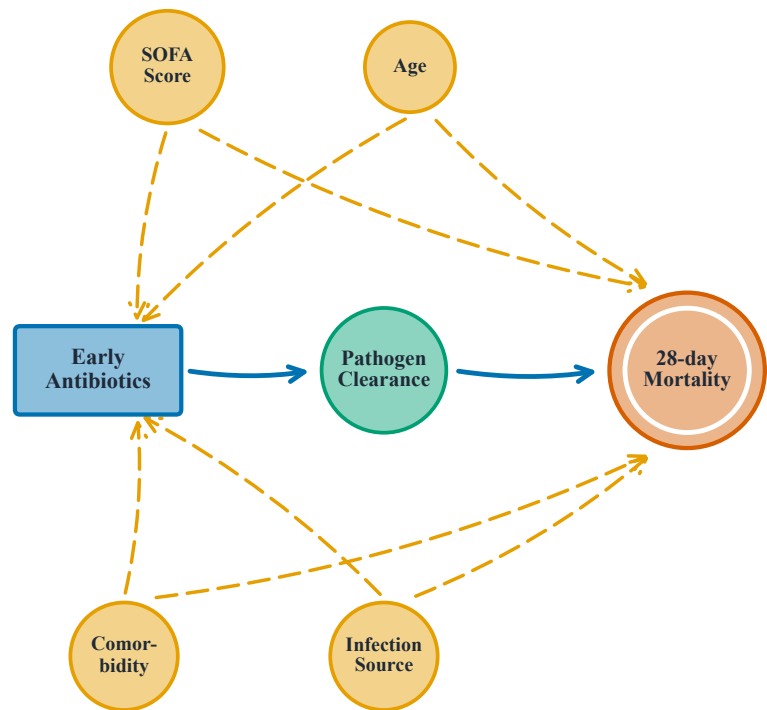
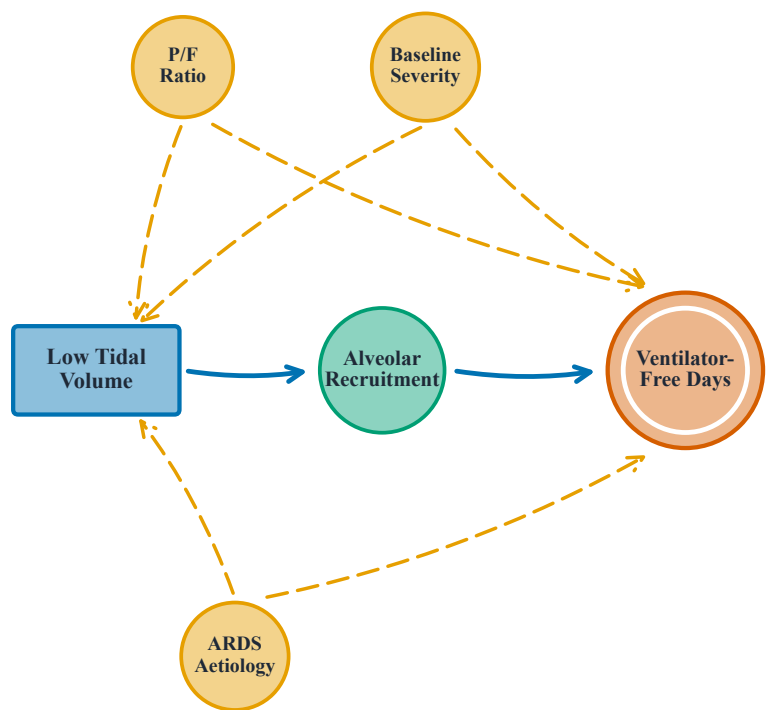


Causal Directed Acyclic Graphs (DAGs) for Three Critical Care Treatment Pathways

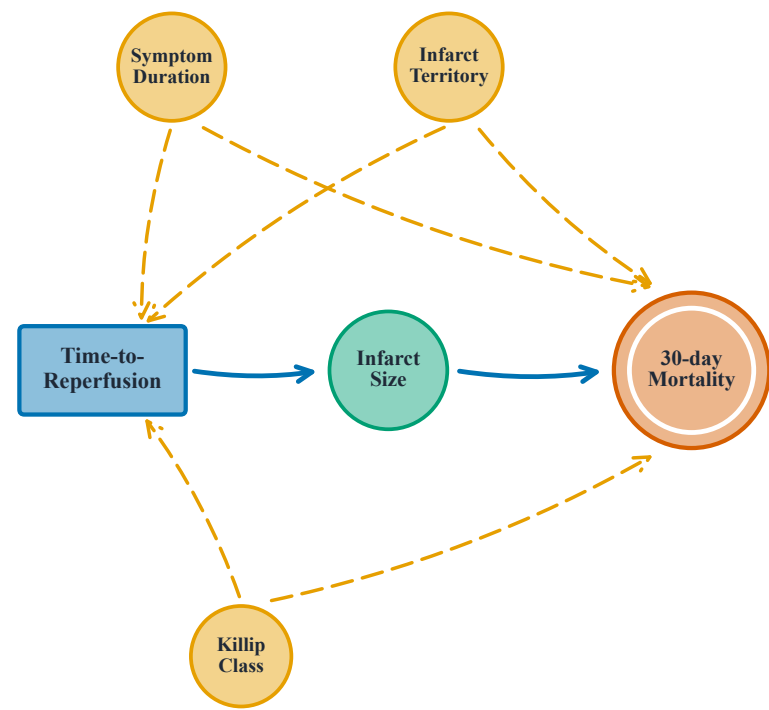
(A) Sepsis: Antibiotic Timing



(B) ARDS: Ventilation Strategy



(C) ACS: Reperfusion Timing



$T = \text{Early Antibiotics } (<3 \text{ h}) \mid Y = \text{28-day Mortality}$

Treatment (T) — rectangle

Outcome (Y) — double circle

$T = \text{Low Tidal Volume } (6 \text{ mL/kg}) \mid Y = \text{Ventilator-Free Days}$

Confounder (Z) — circle

Mediator (M) — circle

Causal path

Backdoor (confounding) path

$T = \text{Door-to-Balloon } (<90 \text{ min}) \mid Y = \text{30-day MACE}$